and Esther Goh titled 'Why Some Children from Poor Families Do Well: An in-depth analysis of positive deviance cases in Singapore', the researchers discovered some children from poorer socio-economic environments were unexpectedly successful. The linkage the researchers found between the financial success of the children in these areas was the result of a strong family connection and an awareness of the family's limited financial resources. The children had particularly strong emotional connections with their mothers which gave them a deep desire to help their families and to find creative ways to financially excel.

In this instance, nurture created the Money Story of wanting to help the family and to give back. It's something that pops up again and again in stories of children whose parents have escaped poverty and hardship to live in another country. In Australia, we have so many examples of this. From Anh Do, a well-known Vietnamese-born Australian author, actor, comedian and painter who also studied a combined Business Law degree at the University of Technology, Sydney, to Majak Daw, an AFL player who arrived from war-torn Sudan, to Harry Triguboff, a property tycoon and multi-billionaire and the son of Russian Jews who fled Russia for China and eventually settled in Australia.

So far, we've been looking at wealth and the family unit but what about when the family unit breaks down? According to a 2018 study by the Australian Council of Social Service, 'children from single parent families … are the hardest hit by poverty in Australia' with 'one in six children (or 739,000 children) living below the poverty line'. In 2017, this represented more than 19 per cent of single-parent families.

We know that children from wealthy parents can sometimes benefit from positive financial modelling. We're also understanding that children from single parent or poorer socio-economic families at times find their lack of financial modelling can lead to limiting financial behaviour in adulthood.

But no matter what socio-economic background or family unit you come from, one of the factors that can have a devastating impact on your finances is childhood or adult trauma. The impact of this can lead people to fill internal voids through limiting and controlling financial behaviour that can include excessively spending or hoarding money.